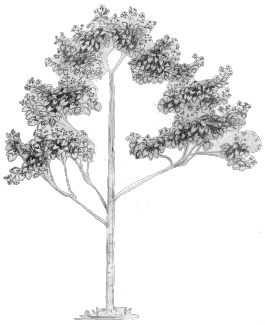
Chapter 23

O aga – The outrigger float

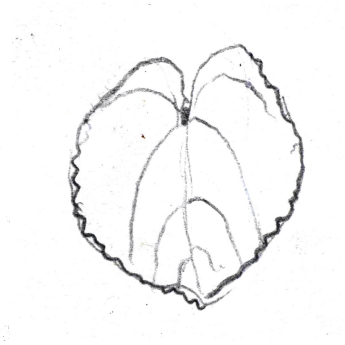
Ruth Sima Rigamu



(a)



(b)



(c)

Figure 1: (a) Young *kopihoo*, (b) Adult *kopihoo*, (c) *Kopihoo* leaf

(1)	*Kopihoo*	*Kopihoo* tree
(2)	*O naono vai o kopihoo na paku riori bono aga no sinivi.*	The *kopihoo* tree is used for making the float of the outrigger canoe.
(3)	*A abana na mosi maari bono kopihoo vai o totobin, ore paa hihi maa bari rasuu, ore paa dee tavus vo hanana.*	The men cut a straight *kopihoo* tree, then they remove its bark in the jungle and carry it out of the bush to a trail.
(4)	*Vaasun vai ori, ore paa raka.*	They stand it up there to dry.

Ruth Sima Rigamu. 2026. *O aga* – the outrigger float. In Ulrike Mosel (ed.), *The material culture of the Teop people of Bougainville*, 175–176. Berlin: Language Science Press. DOI: 10.5281/zenodo.22880272

(5)	*Be raka, ore paa dee voosu maa bari,*	When it is dry, they carry it home
(6)	*ore paa ma taraha bona ihu no kopihoo.*	and plane the surface of the nose of the *kopihoo* log.
(7)	*Ore paa taraha bona meha papana.*	Then they plane the surface of the other side.
(8)	*Be kavara, ore paa asi ni bono buo ihu aga ore tara vamataa.*	After that, they singe the two noses of the float to look beautiful.
(9)	*Bea abana pampamu vakavara ore paa tapa ni bono aga teo sinivi.*	When the men have done the lashing (i.e. have lashed the *vanai* 'boom' to the canoe), they fix the float to (the boom of) the canoe with pegs.
(10)	*O buo naono vai to tapa aga ni raara ei o kopihoo bara o roge.*	The two trees that we build floats from, these are the *kopihoo* tree and the coastal hibiscus.

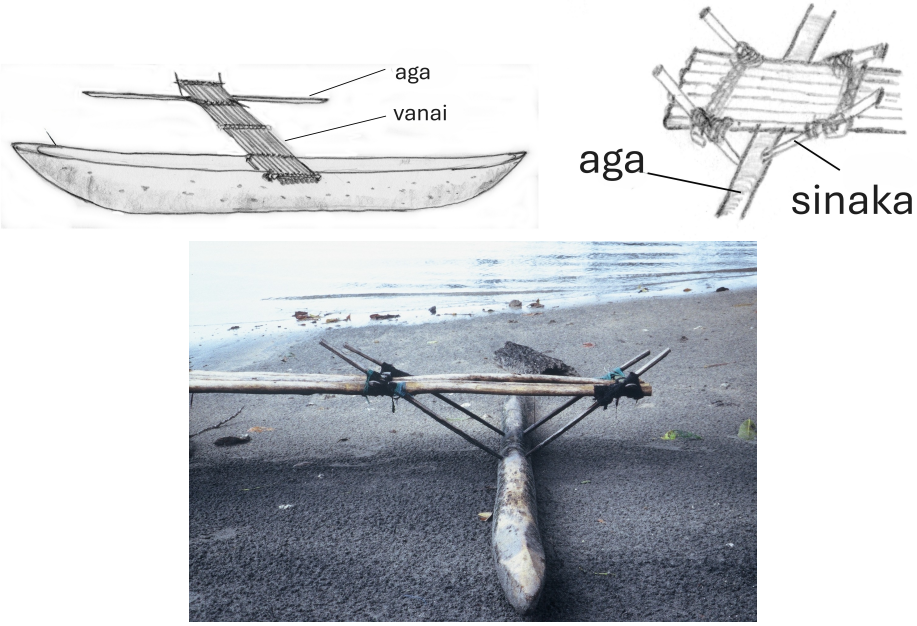


Figure 2: *O aga no sinivi* – The float of the indigenous canoe